CULTURE SHOCK

Your long expectation has finally been realized: you are going to a university abroad. This new challenge and opportunity might soon collide with the reality of being in a new culture, something known as culture shock. Culture shock has been viewed as a psychological reaction or a generalized disorientation and trauma experienced by a person learning to cope with a new culture and circumstances. It is a normal and natural part of living in a foreign cultural environment. Culture shock doesn't mean that one is adjusting poorly - it means that one is undergoing a normal reaction. However, the way that one manages culture shock can have important implications for the success of one's adaptability to the new culture. The psychological reaction in coping with culture shock includes emotional and cognitive components, as well as the effects of social changes. These changes also result in a psychophysiological reaction to the experience of another culture. The changes caused by culture shock include fatigue, role stress and identity loss, excessive concern with cleanliness, and a fear of danger from food and water.

EXERCISE 1: Find words or phrases in the passage which mean the same as:

COLUMN A **COLUMN B**

a) something new, and often exciting , which requires effort and determination to succeed in .....

b) be opposed to; come together violently *(phrase)* . . . . . .

c) confusion; not knowing where one is in relation to other places . . . . . .

d) experience; pass through . . . . . .

e) indication (usually indirectly) . . . . . .

f) related to the process of learning; showing knowledge . . . . . .

g) a part of something which helps to make it complete . . . . . .

EXERCISE 2: Choose the correct answer according to the passage.

1. When someone is exposed to a new culture.....

A) he can find that the challenge is not as great as he believed
B) it often does not live up to his expectations
C) he becomes very homesick, especially for his favourite foods
D) it isn't at all unusual to experience culture shock
E) the necessary adjustment takes a long time

2. It is stated that.....

A) if one doesn't adjust quickly to the new culture, one probably never will
B) successful adjustment to the new culture depends on how one handles the culture shock
C) culture shock is a sign that a person is not capable of adapting to life abroad
D) culture shock may bring about social changes which are difficult to cope with
E) people with psychological or emotional disorders are most likely to suffer from culture shock

3. One of the symptoms of culture shock is that.....

A) one becomes unable to think logically
B) your emotions start going from one extreme to another without warning
C) people lose their appetites and so become undernourished
D) one tends to start believing one is physically ill when one is not
E) the person may be suspicious of what he eats and drinks

EXERCISE 3: Complete the sentences by selecting words from Column B in EXERCISE 1.

1. When he was a child he.....a number of major operations to enable him to walk properly.
2. He enjoys dangerous sports, such as climbing and parachuting, because he sees them as more of a.....than other, safer activities.
3. The basic.....of any language course will be the four skills of reading, writing, speaking, and listening.
4. The loss of that firm's order has a number of serious.....for our company's future.
5. The medicine which the doctor prescribed was so strong that it left her with a strange feeling of.....